## Reflective Report on Chessboxing Coursework using Gibbs' Reflective Cycle

### 1. Description

In the case of Chessboxing coursework, I designed a web page in HTML and CSS. This consisted of highlighting the contents in HTML to give it structure and formatting it through the use of CSS to make it presentable and user-friendly. To structure the content, I used semantic HTML elements: header, nav, main, article, section, figure and figcaption. I also included accessibility elements such as alternative text on images and a skip link, as well as an iframe title on the embedded YouTube video. The CSS work was more elaborate with emphasis on typography, layout and responsiveness to varying screen sizes. I created a stylesheet named chessboxing.css and I employed the custom property, web fonts, and responsive breakpoints.

### 2. Feelings

Initially, I was sure that I could write the HTML, as it has a logical structure. Nevertheless, CSS made me more nervous since it had to be planned and tried more to make the page look pretty across all screen sizes. When I began to work on styling, I felt much more relaxed and liked to watch how minor CSS modifications influenced the design. I got frustrated at times, particularly when the layouts were visible in the smaller screens or the accessibility features failed to do the thing as I wanted them to do. Nevertheless, resolving such problems provided me with an element of achievement, and it helped me feel more competent as a web designer.

### 3. Evaluation

There were sections in the project that were quite successful. The semantic HTML was better in structuring and readability, and simplified the process of styling. The custom property of CSS also assisted me in dealing with spacing and typography. I also designed a responsive video wrapper, which ensured that the embedded YouTube iframe was compatible with all devices. The process of testing my code with W3C validators was useful since it helped me identify mistakes that I made, including missing headings and old attributes. Conversely, there were problems. It was not that easy to strike a balance between visual design and flexibility. I was to make sure that images and figures fitted both narrow screen and wide screen. Another learning curve was accessibility testing with keyboard navigation because I had to examine skip links, focus outlines, and ARIA attributes.

**4. Analysis**

This project demonstrated that although HTML is a definition of structure, CSS brings in an element of complexity in terms of design and responsiveness. It emphasised the need to plan before styling, particularly on typography and layout uniformity. CSS frameworks such as Bootstrap would have made more work load since they can offer responsive grids and ready-made elements, but it would have deprived me of the chance to work with core CSS. Hence, it allowed me, to a greater degree, to do everything manually. I also learned that accessibility and responsiveness are continuous processes, and not a one-time job.

**5. Conclusion**

This experience also taught me that frameworks are not as important as solid knowledge of HTML and CSS. I also realised that web development of professional quality requires accessibility and validation. Though the process has been tough at times, it has helped me gain technical confidence and problem-solving abilities.

**6. Action Plan**

In further product development, I intend to rely on structures such as Bootstrap or Tailwind, but after creating the foundation myself. This will assist in balancing between learning and efficiency. I also want to investigate the new methods, such as CSS container queries, responsive images with the help of the srcset, and service workers with improved performance. I will continue to test with validators and accessibility tools regularly to ensure a high level of standards.

## References


• MDN Web Docs. HTML elements and accessibility guidance. (https://developer.mozilla.org/)

• Bootstrap documentation. (https://getbootstrap.com/)

• W3C HTML and CSS validators. https://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/) 2 (https://validator.w3.org/